



Warty, unripe fruits are used in many Asian dishes.

Bitter melon



HYDROPONIC MELONS

Hydroponics is a method of growing plants indoors in a liquid full of nutrients. It can produce more food than crops grown in soil because of the controlled environment, in which temperature, light, and humidity can be regulated. This is a good method for growing melons, which need a lot of water.



The orange flesh is a good source of vitamins.



Charentais melon

Considered a rare treat, just two of these fruits sold for \$28,000 (£21,500) in Japan in 2016.

Yubari King melon



Jellylike flesh tastes like a cross between a banana and a cucumber.



Sweet, pale green flesh is enclosed within a thick, waxy rind.

Honeydew melon

This thin-skinned fruit can be eaten whole—rind and all.



Korean melon



Santa Claus melon

This melon takes its name from the fact that it keeps well, almost until Christmas!



Horned melon

Kajari, Korean, tigger, Santa Claus, Yubari King, and most of the other melons shown above. Even the odd-looking **horned melon**, an important source of food and water in the Kalahari Desert of Namibia, and the prickly **gac** from southeast Asia,

are related. The most commonly grown melon is the **watermelon**. It's also the heaviest. An average specimen is about 22 lb (10 kg), but the record-breaking biggest weighed in at 350 lb (159 kg)—that's equal to the weight of an adult male panda!

